General rule – multiclassing · "Character Creation" chapter of SRD 5.2.1

Multiclassing lets you gain a level in **another class** instead of your current one. You need **13** in the primary ability of your current class **and** the new one. Character level is the **sum** of class levels (max 20).

The **Proficiency Bonus** depends on total level. You gain the **Hit Points** of the new class, but only **some proficiencies**. Same-name features don't stack (Extra Attack).

🎲 Quick summary:

1. Prerequisite: **13** in the primary ability of both classes.
2. Total level = sum of levels; Proficiency Bonus follows it.
3. Limited proficiencies in the new class.
4. Spell slots: see the table (combined casters).

⚠ Change from 2014

SRD 2024 clarifies the proficiencies gained when multiclassing and the spell slot calculation by caster type.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

Multiclassing stays optional and can unbalance. Fix: the DM allows it or not before play.

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can ask for a narrative reason (a mentor, an encounter) for the class change.

Step 1 – Check prerequisites:

13 in the primary ability of your current and new class.

Step 2 – Take a level:

On level up, choose the new class. Total level rises by 1.

Step 3 – Proficiencies:

You gain only the limited proficiencies of the new class (weapons, armor, skills).

Step 4 – Hit Points:

New class Hit Die: roll it or take the average.

Step 5 – Spells:

Add caster levels per the table for slots; each class keeps its prepared spells.

Example: Elora, Cleric 3, takes one Fighter level: total level 4, Proficiency Bonus +2. She needs Wisdom 13 and Strength or Dexterity 13.

Caster type	Levels counted
Full caster (Bard, Cleric, Druid, Sorcerer, Wizard)	All levels
Half caster (Paladin, Ranger)	Half, rounded up
Third caster (Eldritch Knight, Arcane Trickster)	One third, rounded down
Warlock	Pact Magic: separate slots
Proficiency Bonus	By total character level
Extra Attack	Doesn't stack across classes

Caster level examples

Character	Caster levels
Cleric 3 / Wizard 2	3 + 2 = 5
Paladin 4 / Cleric 2	2 (Paladin, half rounded up) + 2 = 4
Fighter (Eldritch Knight) 6 / Wizard 1	2 (a third of 6) + 1 = 3
Warlock 3 / Wizard 2	Wizard alone: 2; Warlock: separate Pact Magic slots

⚠ Common questions:

What is the prerequisite?

13 in the primary ability of both classes.

Does the Proficiency Bonus change?

It follows total level.

Do I gain all proficiencies?

No: only some.

Do slots combine?

According to the combined casters table.

Does Extra Attack stack?

No: only one feature of the same name.

And Warlock?

Pact Magic slots stay separate.

How many classes?

As many as you want, up to level 20.

⚠ Debate points and table options: Table rule

Optimization

Many powerful combos. **Option**: limit to two classes.

Starting level

Start multiclassed? **Option**: no.

Prerequisite

Ignore the prerequisite. **Option**: no.

Prepared spells

Calculated per class. **Option**: keep it.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

Prerequisite

The 13s are required when taking the level.

Proficiencies

Gained proficiencies are limited, not the level 1 set.

Spells

Prepared spells are computed per class; slots are shared.

Pact Magic

The Warlock's slots serve its pact spells.

These points remain open to discussion: your feedback is welcome to refine this sheet.

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